

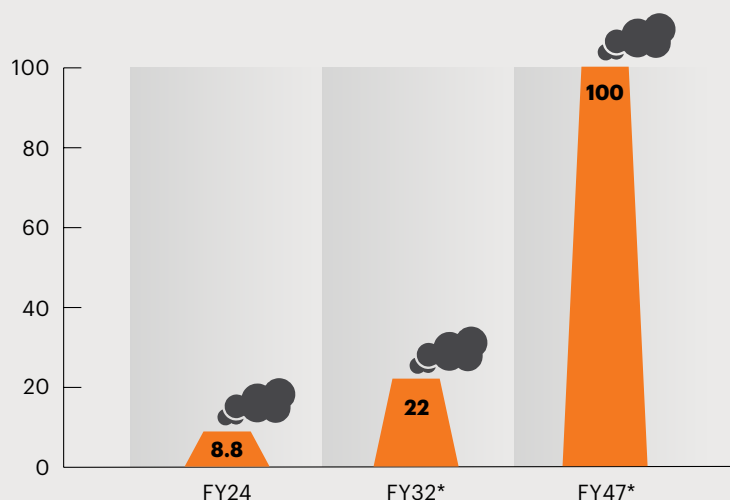


The expansion [nuclear power] will also drive the rise of a new industrial and MSME ecosystem”

NAGESH BASARKAR
MANAGING DIRECTOR,
CORE ENERGY
SYSTEMS LIMITED

PROJECTING POWER

- India will have to add 2 GW capacity per year to reach the 2032 target
- This entire capacity will come from the Centre as private players will take at least five years to build the plants after getting all clearances



NOTE NUCLEAR CAPACITY IN GW; *PROJECTED **SOURCE** NPCIL

The five-year average is 95%. “This being a captive PPA, we would like to understand how the user would be compensated in case of a PLF shortfall. For captive usage, if we consider this as the annual PLF and factor a spinning reserve equivalent for 30% of the total installed capacity, the resultant tariff will be unviable,” RIL has said. Spinning reserve is extra generating capacity already connected to the grid and synchronised with the system frequency, ready to be quickly deployed to handle unexpected changes in power demand or generation.

A number of industry players have asked NPCIL to revisit the suggested PLF. “The plant is expected to operate at the normative PLF of 68.5%. The normative PLF is under consideration for a revision

to 72.5%. However, the actual availability is expected to be higher as per the historical trend of similar operating plants,” NPCIL has said in its response.

There are also concerns over ownership of assets with RIL seeking a “co-licensee” status. Under the proposed structure, the project has to be funded by the company, while licences, permits and approvals will be under some other entity. “We suggest having the company as the co-licensee. We also recommend providing a licence for the entire project life at one go (instead of five years for initial operations). This will provide comfort to the entity and the lenders,” it has added.

ADVANCED TECHNOLOGY

The companies also want the

government to allow adoption of Gen III and Gen IV foreign small modular reactor technologies. The technology being offered by NPCIL is 2011 PHWR. Some are also looking at plants with higher capacity than 220 MW. NPCIL has been operating 500 MW plants and recently inducted its third 700 MW reactor at its plant in Rajasthan.

Jindal’s Ahlawat says they want higher capacity in view of the company’s huge power needs. “We are looking at plants above 700 MW to meet our energy demand. After amendments to the Atomic Energy Act and the Civil Liability for Nuclear Damage Act are cleared, we will have foreign players such as Westinghouse and Rosatom and others wanting to do business in India. There will be a bigger pool of experts, consumers, suppliers and